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Informational Interview Tracker

This agenda worksheet will serve as your tracker for the individual conversations you have for your projects in-course, and what you will use to keep record of your informational interviews as a part of the Job Guarantee program. We recommend using the networking tracker to keep track of your outreach attempts, and this worksheet encompasses your preparation, completion, and submission.

Interviewee Name	**Shalini Chander** 1st degree connection
Interviewee LinkedIn Profile	Shalini Chander | LinkedIn
Date Completed	Apr 16, 2023 (click date to change)
Outreach Message You can use examples from the LinkedIn Connection Requests & Outreach Guide.	Hi Shalini, hope you're doing well! I've been enjoying your recent posts on Agentic AI—it's such a timely shift in the product landscape. I'm currently looking at moving into Technical Program Management roles, specifically within the AI/HealthTech space, and I'd love to pick your brain on the culture at Illumina. Given your history there, I'd value your take on how they handle the friction between R&D and global production. Would you be open to a quick 10-15 min catch-up or coffee in UTC sometime soon? I'd love to hear how things are going at Align as well!
Prepared Questions Remember to prepare 5-10 questions based on the length of time you have	• **The TPM Persona:** "In your experience at Illumina, is the TPM role more focused on 'Agile delivery' of software, or is it a 'Heavylift' role that coordinates between hardware, wet-lab scientists, and software engineering?" • **R&D to Production:** "Coming from Qualcomm/Samsung, I'm used to a 'zero-fault' mass production mindset. How does Illumina manage the transition from a research prototype to a validated clinical product? Who owns that lifecycle?" • **Global Alignment:** "You led global product lines there—what was the biggest challenge in aligning US-based R&D with international commercial requirements? Is that an area where a TPM with a technical bridge background (like mine) can add the most value?" • **Regulatory Hurdles:** "How much does the regulatory/clinical validation process dictate the technical

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	roadmap? Does the TPM need to be a 'subject matter expert' in genomics, or just a master of the execution process?" • **AI Roadmap:** "With the shift toward Agentic AI that you've been posting about, do you see Illumina moving toward more automated 'platform-level' AI, or is it still very feature-specific?" • **On Adoption Friction:** "In your experience at Illumina, what was the biggest hurdle to adopting new technology in the clinical space—was it the underlying science, the regulatory environment, or the operational challenge of updating global customer platforms?" • **On Platform Strategy:** "You managed the internal commercial platform (Customer E-Portal). How does Illumina view AI—is it a standalone feature, or is there a push to make it a unified horizontal layer across their sequencing hardware?" • **On the "Principal" Persona:** "For a leadership role in enablement, does Illumina value the 'Deep Researcher' more, or the 'Architect' who can ensure bit-accurate reliability for mass-market clinical products?" • **On Culture:** "How would you describe the balance between their academic research roots and the production-grade rigor needed for their flagship products? Is it a culture that welcomes the 'zero-fault' mindset from industries like semiconductors?" • **On the Future:** "I saw your post about **Claude vs. ChatGPT Health**. How do you see those infrastructure plays impacting the way companies like Illumina or Align Technology build their own AI ecosystems?"
Notes from Conversation What did you learn? What were your take aways? Resources shared? Action item?	• **Key Learnings:** Shalini mentioned that Illumina is currently hiring heavily for TPMs who understand 'System Integration' rather than just 'Software Scrums. She gave me some insights about company culture and hiring process as well as interview. • **Takeaways:** My background in bit-accurate simulation is actually a huge selling point for their clinical validation teams because it reduces the need for expensive physical testing. • **Resources Shared:** Shalini recommended looking at the 'Sidebar' leadership community or mentioned a specific people I should follow up for further information.

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	• **Action Items:** 1. Send Shalini my "TPM-flavored" resume. 2. Mention her name to the recruiter for the Associate Principal role or get referral to apply. 3. Research 'Illumina Smile Architect' to see how they handle digital experiences.
Thank You Message Sent	Apr 26, 2023
Follow Up Message Sent	Apr 26, 2023
Submission Status	No